

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of Meoncross pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 How much progress did the Romans make in public health?	• Describe the key features of Roman public health infrastructure, including aqueducts, bathhouses, and sewers • Explain how the Roman Empire's centralised power enabled large-scale public health projects • Evaluate the significance of Roman public health by assessing whether it represented genuine medical understanding or imperial prestige	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?	- Explain how the collapse of Roman imperial power led to the decline of organised public health systems - Describe the role of the medieval Church in shaping attitudes to disease and sanitation - Assess the significance of the Black Death (1348) as a turning point in medieval public health	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?	- Describe the public health challenges caused by rapid urbanisation in Early Modern towns - Explain why governments failed to act despite growing evidence of poor sanitation - Evaluate the extent to which continuity, rather than change, defined public health between 1500 and 1750	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why the growth of towns (urbanisation) made public health worse in the Early Modern period.
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?	- Explain how industrialisation and mass migration to cities created unprecedented public health crises - Describe the role of key individuals (John Snow, Edwin Chadwick) in challenging existing beliefs about disease - Analyse the significance of the 1848 Public Health Act as an example of government intervention driven by causation evidence	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why John Snow's discovery at the Broad Street pump was a turning point.
Lesson 5 Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?	- Explain why it took Parliament so long to act on public health reform despite mounting evidence - Describe how the 'Great Stink' of 1858 became a turning point that forced government action - Evaluate the significance of Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system as a landmark of change in public health	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859–1865)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.
Lesson 6 End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation	- Evaluate how Dr John Snow used map data and scientific deduction to prove cholera was waterborne in 1854. - Explain the shift from laissez-faire government attitudes to compulsory state intervention in British public health. - Produce a structured 8-mark explanation assessing the significance of Victorian sanitation reforms.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain the significance of John Snow's discovery during the 1854 Broad Street Cholera outbreak. (8 marks)
Unit Key Vocabulary: Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-Faire • Cesspit • Back-to-back housing • Public Health Act 1848 • Public Health Act 1875 • Broad Street Pump • The Great Stink • Sewage System • Edwin Chadwick • John Snow • Joseph Bazalgette • Industrial Revolution		

KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power (1066–1485)

Year 7 | How did power shift in Medieval England?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?	- Describe the three rival claims to the English throne in 1066 and assess which was strongest - Explain how the Battle of Hastings demonstrated the role of power, luck, and military strategy in shaping history - Evaluate the significance of the Norman Conquest as a turning point in English history	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle for the year 1066; Source B: The Bayeux Tapestry; Source C: The Battle of Hastings (19th Century)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Explain why there was a succession crisis in 1066 and evaluate the claims of the three rivals.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 1: The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) Imagine you are an adviser to the Witan (the council of English lords) in January 1066. Write a short persuasive speech (3–4 sen...
Lesson 2 Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?	- Explain how William used castles, the feudal system, and terror as tools of power and control - Describe how the Domesday Book functioned as a mechanism of royal authority and resistance suppression - Assess the effectiveness of William's methods in crushing Anglo-Saxon resistance	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source C: An extract from the Ecclesiastical History by the Anglo-Norman monk and chronicler Orderic Vitalis.; Source D: An extract from the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, written by contemporary English monks.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the causes and devastating consequences of the Harrying of the North.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region.
Lesson 3 Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?	- Explain why the relationship between the monarchy and the Church was a fundamental struggle for power in medieval England - Describe how the murder of Thomas Becket (1170) demonstrated the tension between feudal loyalty and religious authority - Evaluate the significance of the Becket affair for the balance of power between Church and Crown	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from a letter sent by Thomas Becket in French exile to King Henry II, c. 1166; Extract from the chronicle of Edward Grim, c. 1174–1177  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the reasons for the complete breakdown in relations between Henry and Becket.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164.
Lesson 4 Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?	- Describe the key grievances that led the barons to challenge King John's power - Explain the significance of Magna Carta as a challenge to absolute monarchy and a step towards parliamentary democracy - Evaluate contrasting historical interpretations of Magna Carta: triumph of liberty or selfish baronial power grab?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from Clause 39 of the Magna Carta, June 1215; Adapted from modern historical scholarship on the 1215 settlement  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Historical Interpretations: The Magna Carta  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 3: The Trial of King John (Interpretation) Divide your answer into two parts: 1. You are King John's defense lawyer. Write a short paragraph defending his actions, exp...

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?	- Describe the key features of daily life for the peasantry in a medieval village - Explain how the feudal system and the Church controlled virtually every aspect of a peasant's existence - Assess the extent to which medieval peasants had any real power or agency within the feudal hierarchy	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: A depiction of a busy medieval parish church.; Source B: A medieval record detailing the collection of church tithes from peasant families.; Source C: The famous medieval Doom Painting at Chaldon Church, Surrey, dating from around 1200.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Describe what a tithe was, how it was collected, and why it caused tension between ordinary medieval peasants and the Church.
Lesson 6 Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?	- Describe the causes and spread of the Black Death across medieval England - Explain how the plague shattered the feudal system by empowering the peasantry through labour shortages - Evaluate the significance of the Black Death as a catalyst for change in medieval social order	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from the Statute of Labourers, 1351  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348.
Lesson 7 Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?	- Explain the causes of the Peasants' Revolt, linking them to the decline of feudalism and growing resistance to royal power - Describe the key events of the revolt and the role of leaders like Wat Tyler - Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was a failure or a significant step towards challenging the power of the monarchy and Parliament	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from a sermon by John Ball, recorded in Jean Froissart's Chronicles  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyze the extent of the threat posed by the rebels when they captured London.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?
Lesson 8 Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) – How did the medieval era end in blood?	- Describe the causes of the Wars of the Roses and how rival claims to the monarchy led to civil war - Explain how propaganda and political manipulation shaped the conflict between York and Lancaster - Evaluate the significance of Henry VII's victory at Bosworth as the end of the medieval era and the birth of Tudor power	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source C: An extract from the contemporary account 'How Richard III Made Himself King' by the Italian traveler Dominic Mancini, written in the summer of 1483.; Source D: A portrait of King Richard III, painted by an unknown artist in the sixteenth century.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 9 Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?	- Synthesise knowledge of power, monarchy, feudalism, and the Church across the medieval period - Construct a sustained argument evaluating how far a medieval monarch's power was limited by resistance from barons, the Church, and the peasantry - Deploy specific historical evidence to support a judgement about the nature of medieval power	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Interpretation A: A modern historian writing about the early Norman period.; Interpretation B: A modern historian writing about the Later Middle Ages.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: To evaluate differing historical interpretations of medieval royal power.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 1: Which of the two interpretations do you find more convincing? Explain your answer using your own knowledge.

Unit Key Vocabulary: Power • Claim • Conquest • Anglo-Saxon • Significance • Feudal system • Resistance • Propaganda • Domesday Book • Motte-and-bailey • Church • Monarchy • Martyr • Excommunication • Canon law • Magna Carta • Democracy • Parliament • Interpretation • Baron •

